

How firm a foundation

Text: "K" in Rippon's
Selection of Hymns, 1787
FOUNDATION (BELLEVUE) 11 11. 11 11

Music: American folk melody, in Joseph Funk's
Genuine Church Music, 1st ed., 1832



The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat) and a 3/2 time signature. The melody consists of 16 measures, with the final measure being a double bar line. The lyrics are arranged in five systems, each corresponding to a line of the hymn. The first system contains the first line of the hymn, the second system contains the second line, the third system contains the third line, the fourth system contains the fourth line, and the fifth system contains the fifth line. The lyrics are as follows:

1 How firm a foun - da - tion, ye saints of the Lord,
2 "Fear not, I am with thee; O be not dis - mayed,
3 "When through the deep wa - ters I call thee to go,
4 "When through fi - ery tri - als thy path - way shall lie,
5 "The soul that on Je - sus still leans for re - pose,
1 is laid for your faith in his ex - cel - lent Word!
2 for I am thy God, and will still give thee aid.
3 the riv - ers of sor - row shall not o - ver - flow,
4 my grace, all - suf - fi - cient, shall be thy sup - ply.
5 I will not, I will not de - sert to its foes.
1 What more can he say than to you he hath said,
2 I'll strength - en thee, help thee, and cause thee to stand,
3 for I will be with thee, thy trou - bles to bless,
4 The flame shall not hurt thee. I on - ly de - sign
5 That soul, though all hell should en - deav - or to shake,
1 to you who for ref - uge to Je - sus have fled?
2 up - held by my right - eous, om - ni - po - tent hand.
3 and sanc - ti - fy to thee thy deep - est dis - tress.
4 thy dross to con - sume, and thy gold to re - fine.
5 I'll nev - er, no nev - er, no nev - er for - sake!"